

Homework 12: Advanced Business English for Aspiring CEOs

Student: IHSAN (Sales Manager → Future CEO)
Teacher: AHSAN **Deadline:** November 6, 2025

Topic: Global Vocabulary Variations & 20 Hard CEO-Level Words

1. Part 1 — How the SAME Word Means DIFFERENT Things in Different Countries

English is the global language of business, but **the same word can have different meanings** depending on American English (AmE), British English (BrE), or International Business English.

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Word	AmE Meaning	BrE Meaning	Business Context Tip
Table	To discuss an idea	To postpone a decision	“Let’s table this merger.” → Postpone (AmE) or Discuss now (BrE)?
Billion	1,000,000,000	1,000,000,000,000 (old BrE)	Always confirm: “1 billion USD = 10”
Rubber	Eraser	Condom	Don’t say “pass the rubber” in a US meeting!
Pants	Trousers	Underwear	“Smart pants” = formal trousers (BrE), underwear (AmE)
Scheme	Fraud/plan (negative)	Plan (neutral)	“New growth scheme” = good in BrE, suspicious in AmE

How to Understand Context:

- Listen for accent (AmE = “schedule” /skdul/, BrE = /djul/)
- Check numbers (1 billion = 10 globally now)
- Ask clarifying questions: “Do you mean postpone or discuss?”
- Use neutral terms: “postpone”, “trousers”, “plan”

2. Part 2 — 20 Hard CEO-Level Vocabulary Words

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#	Word	Easy Synonym	Example Sentence
1	Paradigm	Model	"Digital transformation is the new paradigm for furniture retail."
2	Synergy	Team power	"The merger will create synergy between design and sales."
3	Leverage	Use smartly	"We will leverage our showroom network to launch online sales."
4	Disrupt	Shake up	"IKEA disrupted the furniture industry with flat-pack design."
5	Pivot	Change direction	"We must pivot from B2C to B2B corporate contracts."
6	Scalability	Ability to grow	"Cloud inventory software offers high scalability."
7	Stakeholder	Interested party	"Our stakeholders include investors, employees, and suppliers."
8	KPI	Success metric	"Customer retention rate is our top KPI this quarter."
9	ROI	Profit return	"The new showroom has a 24-month ROI."
10	Agile	Flexible & fast	"We use agile methodology for product launches."
11	Discretionary	Optional	"CEO has discretionary budget for innovation."
12	Due Diligence	Deep check	"We completed due diligence before acquiring the factory."
13	EBITDA	Profit before costs	"Our EBITDA grew 18% despite supply chain issues."
14	Capex	Big investments	"Capex for the new warehouse is \$2.1M."
15	Churn	Customer loss	"Reducing churn from 12% to 5% is our goal."
16	Moat	Competitive wall	"Our custom design software is our economic moat."
17	Runway	Time before cash ends	"With \$5M in the bank, we have 18 months of runway."
18	Inflection Point	Turning moment	"E-commerce sales hit an inflection point in Q3."
19	Arbitrage	Profit from difference	"We do price arbitrage between EU and US markets."
20	Governance	Rules & control	"Strong corporate governance builds investor trust."

3. Part 3 — Multiple Choice Questions

1. “Let’s table this discussion.” → In American English, this means: A) Discuss now B) **Postpone** C) Cancel
2. Which is a KPI for a furniture CEO? A) Number of Instagram likes B) **Average order value (AOV)** C) Employee birthday parties
3. “We need to pivot.” means: A) Buy new office chairs B) **Change business strategy fast** C) Paint the showroom
4. Due diligence is done BEFORE: A) **Signing a contract** B) Celebrating a deal C) Sending invoices
5. A company with high churn: A) Has loyal customers B) **Loses customers fast** C) Sells churners

4. Part 4 — Exercises

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blank

1. The CEO approved \$500K in
for a new robotic assembly line. (Capex)
2. Our
is our patented wood-finishing process. (Moat)
3. We must
from retail to contract furniture for hotels. (Pivot)
4.
shows profit before interest, taxes, etc. (EBITDA)
5. Strong
prevents corruption scandals. (Governance)

Exercise 2: Match the Synonym

- A. Leverage → 2. Use smartly
- B. Disrupt → 1. Shake up
- C. Scalability → 3. Ability to grow

Exercise 3: Correct the Sentence

- “We will rubber this idea later.”
“We will **table** this idea later.” (or “postpone”)

5. Part 5 — Final Homework: Video Recording

Task: You are the CEO giving a quarterly update to investors. Record a 3–5 minute video (in English) and send to Teacher Ahsan.

Include all:

1. 1 vocabulary difference (e.g., table = postpone in AmE)
2. At least 8 CEO-level words
3. 1 KPI result (invent realistic numbers)
4. 1 future plan (use “pivot” or “leverage”)
5. End with “We are building the future of furniture.”

Video Tips

Speak clearly, look at the camera, use gestures, wear business attire. File name: IHSAN_HW12_CEO_Update.mp4

Send to

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Grading (Teacher Ahsan's Note)

Vocabulary use: 40% Clarity & confidence: 30% Structure & content: 30%

“Ihsan, you are SO close to thinking like a CEO. This homework will make investors listen when you speak. Record with confidence — I believe in you!”